

How This Portfolio Was Built

A record of the source material, design decisions and file structure behind **nithya-portfolio** — the personal site for Velicharla Nithya, B.Sc. Computer Science & Cloud Computing, Loyola Academy, Hyderabad.

1. Starting point

The only input was a one-page resume PDF. Its text was extracted with the `pypdf` library and mapped onto the site's sections, so every line on the site traces back to the resume — nothing was invented.

- Professional summary → the About section
- Technical skills (8 items) → the skills card grid
- Education, with Intermediate 85% and SSC 9.8 GPA → the education table
- Achievements and core strengths → the list and chips at the end

2. Design decisions

The visual direction came from the subject: the precision of a cadet's training, paired with the cool, technical world of cloud infrastructure.

Choice	What was used	Why
Palette	Brass #9A6E18 accent, deep teal #1C6B67, cool slate neutrals	Brass carries the NCC and dance side; slate keeps the technical side calm.
Typefaces	Familjen Grotesk headings, Source Serif 4 body, IBM Plex Mono labels	Three roles, each doing one job. The mono gives labels and scores a technical edge.
Layout	Sticky left identity rail, scrolling content column	A recruiter always sees the name and contact details, whatever they scroll to.

3. What is in the repository

File	Purpose
index.html	The complete site — markup, CSS and JavaScript in one self-contained file. No build step, no dependencies, no framework.
README.md	Project readme with GitHub Pages instructions.
.gitignore	Excludes Windows and editor junk (Thumbs.db, desktop.ini, .DS_Store, *.tmp).
docs/	This documentation PDF.

How the page is put together

4. Structure

The document is a two-column CSS grid. Below 960px it collapses to one column and the rail becomes an ordinary header, so the page works on a phone.

```
.shell grid: 330px rail + content column
header.rail name, course, nav, email, phone (sticky)
main #about #skills #education
#achievements #strengths #contact
```

5. The theme system

Every colour is a CSS custom property defined in three places, so the page is correct for all three reader states: system light, system dark, and an explicit choice.

```
:root -> the light palette
@media (prefers-color-scheme:dark) -> dark values, guarded so an
:root:not([data-theme="light"]) explicit light choice wins
:root[data-theme="dark"] -> the toggle wins either way
```

No component hard-codes a colour; each reads a token. The Theme button sets data-theme on the root element, swapping the whole palette in one step.

6. Behaviour and accessibility

- **Scroll reveal** — an IntersectionObserver fades each section in once, then stops watching it.
- **Nav highlighting** — a second observer marks the link for whichever section is on screen.
- **Reduced motion** — readers whose system asks for less motion see every section immediately, with no animation.
- **Keyboard** — a visible brass focus ring on every link and button.
- **Real links** — mailto: and tel:, so a recruiter on a phone can tap to call.

7. Editing the content later

Open index.html in any text editor; the sections follow the resume order. To add a skill, copy one card and change its two lines of text:

```
<div class="card"><h3>Docker</h3>
<p class="note">Containers & images</p></div>
```

Version control and publishing

8. Getting it onto GitHub

The project folder was turned into a Git repository, committed, and pushed to `github.com/Ramyasamudralaa/nithya-portfolio` on branch `main`.

```
git init -b main
git add -A
git commit -m "Add portfolio site for Velicharla Nithya"
git remote add origin \
https://github.com/Ramyasamudralaa/nithya-portfolio.git
git push -u origin main
```

The first push stalled: GitHub needed a sign-in and the automated shell had no way to show the login window. Once the Git Credential Manager sign-in was completed on the desktop, the credentials were cached and the retry went straight through. The result was verified with `git ls-remote origin`, which showed `refs/heads/main` at the same commit as the local branch.

9. Publishing with GitHub Pages

Step	Action
1	Open the repository on GitHub and go to Settings → Pages .
2	Under Source , choose Deploy from a branch .
3	Select branch <code>main</code> , folder <code>/</code> (root), Save.
4	After about a minute the site is live at <code>https://ramyasamudralaa.github.io/nithya-portfolio/</code>

10. Publishing a change

After editing `index.html`, three commands put the change online. GitHub Pages rebuilds within a minute of the push.

```
git add -A
git commit -m "Update skills section"
git push
```

11. Worth knowing

- Fonts load from Google Fonts. Offline the page still works, falling back to Georgia, Segoe UI and Consolas.
- No server, no database, no tracking — one static file, which is why it loads instantly and costs nothing to host.
- The repository is public, so the email address and phone number are visible to anyone. Normal for a portfolio, but a deliberate choice worth knowing.